

3). Let $V = \mathbb{R}^n$ (or $\mathbb{C}^n$). Let $S = \{\vec{x}_1, \dots, \vec{x}_m\}$ where $m > n$, then S is linearly dependent.

Proof: Denote $A = \begin{pmatrix} \vec{x}_1 & \vec{x}_2 & \dots & \vec{x}_m \end{pmatrix} \in \mathbb{R}^{n \times m}$ (or $\mathbb{C}^{n \times m}$)

$\{\vec{x}_1, \dots, \vec{x}_m\}$ linearly dep. $\Leftrightarrow \exists c_1, \dots, c_m$ not all zero such that $c_1 \vec{x}_1 + c_2 \vec{x}_2 + \dots + c_m \vec{x}_m = \vec{0}$

$\Leftrightarrow A\vec{x} = \vec{0}$ has non-trivial solutions $\Leftrightarrow \text{Null}(A) \neq \{\vec{0}\} \Leftrightarrow \dim(\text{Null}(A)) > 0 \Leftrightarrow \text{nullity}(A) > 0$. proved below!

By rank-nullity thm: $\text{rank}(A) + \text{nullity}(A) = m$. as $\text{rank}(A) \leq n$, $\text{nullity}(A) \geq m - n > 0$.

4). A set containing the zero vector is automatically linearly dependent. Jan 10.

Definition: A set $S \subseteq V$ is linearly dependent if S contains a linearly dependent finite set.

Definition: A set $S \subseteq V$ is linearly independent if every finite subset of S is linearly independent.

Basis, Dimension

Definition: A subset $S \subseteq V$ is a basis of V if it satisfies the following two conditions:

1) S is linearly independent, and

2) $V = \text{Span } S$, i.e. $\forall \vec{v} \in V: \exists \vec{x}_1, \dots, \vec{x}_n \in S$ and scalars $a_1, \dots, a_n$ such that $\vec{v} = a_1 \vec{x}_1 + a_2 \vec{x}_2 + \dots + a_n \vec{x}_n$.

Corollary. Let $S = \{\vec{x}_1, \vec{x}_2, \dots, \vec{x}_n\} \subseteq V$ be a basis of V . Then $\forall \vec{v} \in V$, there exists a unique n -tuple $a_1, \dots, a_n$ such that $\vec{v} = a_1 \vec{x}_1 + \dots + a_n \vec{x}_n$.

Proof. Suppose there exists scalars $a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n, b_1, b_2, \dots, b_n$ such that

$$\vec{x} = a_1 \vec{x}_1 + a_2 \vec{x}_2 + \dots + a_n \vec{x}_n = b_1 \vec{x}_1 + b_2 \vec{x}_2 + \dots + b_n \vec{x}_n$$

$$\text{Then } a_1 \vec{x}_1 + a_2 \vec{x}_2 + \dots + a_n \vec{x}_n = b_1 \vec{x}_1 + b_2 \vec{x}_2 + \dots + b_n \vec{x}_n$$

$$\Leftrightarrow (a_1 - b_1)\vec{x}_1 + (a_2 - b_2)\vec{x}_2 + \dots + (a_n - b_n)\vec{x}_n = \vec{0}$$

Since $\{\vec{x}_1, \vec{x}_2, \dots, \vec{x}_n\}$ is linearly independent

$$a_1 - b_1 = a_2 - b_2 = \dots = a_n - b_n = 0$$

$$\Leftrightarrow a_1 = b_1, a_2 = b_2, \dots, a_n = b_n \quad \square$$

Theorem (Replacement Theorem). Let V be a vector space. Let $G \subseteq V$ such that G contains n vectors and $V = \text{Span } G$. If $L \subseteq V$ is a linearly independent set or an empty set, which contains m vectors. Then

1). $m \leq n$ and

2). There exists a subset $H \subseteq G$ such that H contains exactly $n-m$ vectors and $\text{Span } L \cup H = V$.

Proof. Proof by induction on m .

Base case: When $m=0$, then $L = \emptyset$. Then $1) m \leq n$ and take $H = G$.

Then H contains $n-0 = n$ vectors and $\text{Span}(L \cup H) = \text{Span } G = V$.

Inductive steps. Suppose the statement is true for any linearly independent set in V containing k vectors. Then we need to prove that the statement is also true for any linearly independent set containing $k+1$ vectors.

i.e. Let $L = \{\vec{x}_1, \dots, \vec{x}_k, \vec{x}_{k+1}\} \subseteq V$ be a linearly independent set in V , then

we need to prove: 1) $n \geq k+1 \Leftrightarrow n-k > 0$ and

2) there exists $H \subseteq V$ such that $V = \text{Span}(L \cup H)$ and H contains $n-k-1$ vectors.

Consider $L' = \{\vec{x}_1, \dots, \vec{x}_k\} \subseteq V$. Then L' is also linearly independent in V and it contains k vectors.

By inductive hypothesis, 1) $n \geq k$ and 2) there exists $H' = \{\vec{y}_1, \dots, \vec{y}_{n-k}\} \subseteq G$

such that $V = \text{span}(L' \cup H') = \text{span}\{\vec{x}_1, \dots, \vec{x}_k, \vec{y}_1, \dots, \vec{y}_{n-k}\}$

As $\{\vec{x}_1, \dots, \vec{x}_k, \vec{y}_1, \dots, \vec{y}_{n-k}\}$ is a spanning set of V , and $\vec{x}_{k+1} \in V$,

$$\exists c_1, \dots, c_k, d_1, \dots, d_{n-k} \quad \vec{x}_{k+1} = c_1 \vec{x}_1 + \dots + c_k \vec{x}_k + d_1 \vec{y}_1 + \dots + d_{n-k} \vec{y}_{n-k} \quad (*)$$

1) Proof of " $n-k > 0$ ": proof by contradiction: Suppose $n-k \leq 0$
as $n-k \geq 0$ (by the inductive hypothesis): $n=k$.

$$\text{Then } H' = \emptyset \Rightarrow \vec{x}_{k+1} = c_1 \vec{x}_1 + \dots + c_k \vec{x}_k$$

$$\Leftrightarrow c_1 \vec{x}_1 + c_2 \vec{x}_2 + \dots + c_k \vec{x}_k + (-1) \vec{x}_{k+1} = \vec{0}$$

$\Rightarrow \{\vec{x}_1, \vec{x}_2, \dots, \vec{x}_k, \vec{x}_{k+1}\}$ is linearly dependent, a contradiction.

2) Constructing H such that $H \subseteq G$, $\text{span } L \cup H = V$ and $|H| = n-k-1$.

Note that in (*), at least one of $d_1, d_2, \dots, d_{n-k}$ is non-zero
(otherwise, if $d_1 = \dots = d_{n-k} = 0$, then $\vec{x}_{k+1} = c_1 \vec{x}_1 + \dots + c_k \vec{x}_k$, then again it implies $\{\vec{x}_1, \dots, \vec{x}_k, \vec{x}_{k+1}\}$ is linearly dependent, a contradiction)

Without loss of generality, we may assume $d_{n-k} \neq 0$.

$$\text{Then: } \vec{x}_{k+1} = c_1 \vec{x}_1 + \dots + c_k \vec{x}_k + d_1 \vec{y}_1 + \dots + d_{n-k} \vec{y}_{n-k}$$

$$\Leftrightarrow \vec{y}_{n-k} = \frac{1}{d_{n-k}} (\vec{x}_{k+1} - c_1 \vec{x}_1 - \dots - c_k \vec{x}_k - d_1 \vec{y}_1 - \dots - d_{n-k-1} \vec{y}_{n-k-1}) \quad (\Delta)$$

Let $H = \{\vec{y}_1, \dots, \vec{y}_{n-k-1}\} \subseteq G$ then H contains exactly $n-k-1$ vectors.

$\forall \vec{x} \in V$: As $\text{span } L' \cup H = V$, $\exists a_1, \dots, a_k, b_1, \dots, b_{n-k-1}$ such that

$$\vec{x} = a_1 \vec{x}_1 + a_2 \vec{x}_2 + \dots + a_k \vec{x}_k + b_1 \vec{y}_1 + b_2 \vec{y}_2 + \dots + b_{n-k+1} \vec{y}_{n-k+1} + b_{n-k} \vec{y}_{n-k}$$

↓ plug in Δ

$$= a_1 \vec{x}_1 + \dots + a_k \vec{x}_k + b_1 \vec{y}_1 + \dots + b_{n-k+1} \vec{y}_{n-k+1}$$

$$+ b_{n-k} \left[\frac{1}{d_{n-k}} \left(\vec{x}_{k+1} - c_1 \vec{x}_1 - \dots - c_k \vec{x}_k - d_1 \vec{y}_1 - \dots - d_{n-k-1} \vec{y}_{n-k-1} \right) \right]$$

$$= \left(a_1 - \frac{b_{n-k} c_1}{d_{n-k}} \right) \vec{x}_1 + \dots + \left(a_k - \frac{b_{n-k} c_k}{d_{n-k}} \right) \vec{x}_k + \frac{b_{n-k}}{d_{n-k}} \vec{x}_{k+1} + \left(b_1 - \frac{b_{n-k} d_1}{d_{n-k}} \right) \vec{y}_1 + \dots + \left(b_{n-k-1} - \frac{b_{n-k} d_{n-k-1}}{d_{n-k}} \right) \vec{y}_{n-k-1}$$

$$\in \text{Span} \left\{ \underbrace{\vec{x}_1, \dots, \vec{x}_{k+1}}_L, \underbrace{\vec{y}_1, \dots, \vec{y}_{n-k-1}}_H \right\} = \text{Span } L \cup H$$

$$\Rightarrow V \subseteq \text{Span } L \cup H.$$

$$\text{As } L \subseteq V \text{ and } H \subseteq V, \text{ Span } L \cup H \subseteq V$$

$$\Rightarrow V = \text{Span } L \cup H. \quad \square$$

Corollary. Let V be a vector space having a finite basis. Then every basis of V contains the same number of vectors.

Proof: Let B_1 and B_2 be two bases of V with $|B_1| = n_1$ and $|B_2| = n_2$.

Then B_1 and B_2 are both linearly independent and $\text{Span } B_1 = \text{Span } B_2 = V$.

Then applying the replacement theorem by taking $G = B_1$ (as $\text{Span } G = \text{Span } B_1 = V$)

and $L = B_2$ (as $L = B_2$ is linearly independent), we can conclude $n_1 \geq n_2$.

applying the replacement theorem again by applying $G = B_2$ (as $\text{Span } G = \text{Span } B_2 = V$)

and $L = B_1$ (as $L = B_1$ is linearly independent), we can conclude that $n_2 \geq n_1$.

$$\Rightarrow n_1 = n_2$$

$\square$.

Definition: Let S be a basis of V .

- 1). If S is a finite set, then the number of vectors in S is called the dimension of V , and V is called a finite-dimensional vector space.
- 2). If S contains infinitely many vectors, then V is called an infinite-dimensional vector space.

Corollary. Let V be a finite-dimensional vector space with $\dim V = n$.

- (1). Any linearly independent subset of V which contains exactly n vectors is a basis of V .
- (2) Any subset of V which spans V is a basis of V .

Proof: Let $S = \{\vec{v}_1, \dots, \vec{v}_n\} \subseteq V$ such that S is linearly independent.

Let B be a basis of V . Then $|B| = n$.

Use the notation in the replacement theorem, take $G = B$, and $L = S$.

Then there exists a set H with $|H| = |G| - |L| = n - n = 0$. Such that

$\text{Span}(L \cup H) = V$. Here, as $|H| = 0$, $H = \emptyset$. and $L = S$

$\Rightarrow \text{Span}(L \cup H) = \text{Span } S = V$.

$\Rightarrow S$ is a spanning set of V

$\Rightarrow S$ is a basis of V . // end of Jan 13

(2). Suppose $S = \{\vec{v}_1, \dots, \vec{v}_n\}$ and $\text{Span } S = V$. Then suppose towards a contradiction

that S is linearly dependent. Then there exists $S' \subsetneq S$ such that

$\text{Span } S' = V$. Use the notation in the replacement theorem: take $G = S'$

then $|G| < n$, and take L to be any basis of V . Then $|L| = n$.